

Drinks in the Parade*

Matt, Ray and Geoff

2008–2009



* and other adventures

14 December 2007

Dear all,

As is now customary there will be drinks in the Parade bar tonight from 5.30pm. We will be celebrating the holiday as well as several people's graduation, and commiserating me on my impending old age (24 on Monday)!

Cheers,
Matt

PS I had a dream last night that the price of lager in the Parade on Friday evenings had gone up. A scary dream indeed – let's hope it's not true!

Part I
2008

29 February

Dear all,

Only once in four years does a chance like this come along...

The chance to drink in the Parade on 29th Feb.

Woo!

See you there,

Matt

PS Girls, this is also your chance to ask Ray to marry you. Woo! Apparently even if he rejects you, to soften the blow he has to provide you with “a kiss, a pound currency, and a pair of gloves”. Woo hoo! (http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/February_29)

Wed, 19 March

Given the fact that the university is shut on Friday (and that some people are apparently going home tomorrow evening), as was suggested last week, we are planning to have our weekly parade drinks tonight instead.

Usual Friday craziness applies – just on a Wednesday. This includes a sweepstake to see how many cadburys crème eggs Matt (he only has the monopoly on Friday drinks, which is why I'm sending the email today) can fit into his mouth without choking.

Please let me know if you plan to attend (or if you'd prefer tomorrow), to spare me from sitting in the pub on my own. Not that I've ever done that before?

Come celebrate Easter with me or the bunny gets it



Ps please note happy hour does not apply tonight so bring some extra money than normal!

4 April

Yes it's that time of the week already. I know Zhivko cries whenever the email doesn't appear, so I thought I best do it. Also I'm sending it early just in case the power goes off and access to emails is lost. Remember to save your work!

"To protect our servers from damage if they suddenly lose power, we will as usual, be powering them down on Friday afternoon (4th April 2008).

This will mean that all services will stop including: Email, printing, home directories, LCPU and all our servers.. and so on.

Save all your edits and start to logout say from 4PM if possible on Friday.

Sorry to remind you about this but I am just the messenger and Estates are the ones powering off our building.

Computer support will be back in on Monday morning to start

things off again.

Regards,

Mark Willis

Computer Support"

So make sure you send your emails saying how wonderful I am while you can.

See you in the parade bar later on.

Ray

18 April

Howdy folks,

It's Friday again! In case you hadn't noticed, that means drinks in the parade at 5.30pm.

After Wiles' birthday last week, today is unfortunately Einstein's deathday. Don't let that put you off though. Come along and raise a glass in memory of the great man (last century's Man of the Century!).

Cheers,
Matt

2 May

It seems like its up to me to send the email this week (apologies if its already just been sent by someone else...).

Yes its Friday, which means its drinks day. Come celebrate the bank holiday by watching Bruce and Matt dance a merry jig round the maypole.

While I am quite a sad individual I dont actually know if its anyone's birthday today, so you'll have to raise a glass to someone at random this week

See you in the parade bar around 5:30

Ray

16 May

Hello,

Seems like everyone's off enjoying the er sun (or possibly the stats seminar). So the reminder is from me this week. Parade drinks, in the parade bar of course, at around 5:30pm.

Im sure someone will email to say which mathematicians birthday it is today. But I'm not going to celebrate it, as I hate them all for inventing maths.

see you all later

Ray

30 May

Dear all,

On this day in 1832, early in the morning, Évariste Galois took part in a duel. He was shot in the abdomen, and died the next day, aged 20. This is possibly the most dramatic death in the mathematicians' canon - rivalled only by that of Tycho Brahé (but you'll have to wait till October for that one).

Last night Galois spent frantically writing out in a letter to his friend all the maths he could think of, in case he died today. Hermann Weyl once said that "This letter, if judged by the novelty and profundity of ideas it contains, is perhaps the most substantial piece of writing in the whole literature of mankind."

After this, he was probably pretty tired, and probably went to the Parade bar (or his local equivalent) for a drink to calm his nerves before the duel. Probably around 5.30am, but we could go at 5.30pm instead.

Also in the news today:

Joan of Ark burned at the stake

Stevie G born (there's one for Ray)

Cheers,

Matt

6 June

Hi folks,

A couple of birthdays to report today: Zorn (of Zorn's Lemma fame) and Lyapunov (of Lyapunov's inequality fame). Another joke for you here:

What's yellow and equivalent to the axiom of choice?

Zorn's Lemon!

Also it's the birthday of explosive former Ghana and Leeds striker Tony Yeboah, and Middlesex batter, Ashes winning captain and renowned doughnut-eater Mike Gatting. As well as American actor Walter Abel, who reminds me of famous Norwegian mathematician Niels Henrik Abel, which reminds me of another joke,

What's purple and commutes?

An abelian grape!

(I told you I knew some bad ones)

Anyway all these birthdays give us lots to celebrate. Come to the Parade bar at 5.30 – it'll be great!

That's all folks,
Matt

4 July

Yup its friday, so that means drinks in the parade bar.

This weeks birthday goes to Ug the Caveman, who was born 12,000 years ago to this very day! He is best known for possibly being the first ever mathematician, when he realised that bashing people's heads with two clubs was much better than using one.

see you later

Ray

25 July

Hello.

It's Friday and the end of another week. Come celebrate all that hard work that you've done this week *ahem*.

Some bloke called Johann Benedict Listing was born today. Apparently he was good in Topology, but quite frankly I don't care too much. No other birthdays and not even any deaths today! So I'm off to kill a mathematician, so people can celebrate next year. Any volunteers?

Anyway after some rumblings about the timing of the drinks last week, a couple of us are meeting earlier this week (around 3.30–4) and also to celebrate what's possibly Ronnie's last parade drinks. People will still be around afterwards for any latecomers.

See you there!

Ray

26 September

Its Friday which can only mean one thing! No I don't mean you should go out and eat a cadbury's crunchie, I mean you should get yourself down to the parade bar for some drinks.

Its a new term, which means lots of young undergrad folk running around stealing our food and beer. However hopefully this means that happy "hour" has returned and that unlike recent weeks the prices have gone down and not up (just staying the same would help).

For the new folk about, I just want to introduce myself as the resident alcoholic/nutjob. Every Friday people meet up for drinks in the parade bar. So if any of you are about, come along and meet your fellow geeks, er I mean mathematicians. To find us, just look out for the large empty area where normal people don't dare to go. Failing that just let me know and I'll keep an eye out for you. Don't worry if you're not about today as there will be a proper night out sometime next week, for people to get to know each other. It will held in some secret location (ie I dont know yet), most likely on thursday or friday.

Hope to see lots of you there!

Ray

ps to keep Matt happy, Mobius apparently died 140 years ago.

Pub Evening: Thursday 7:30 (2 October)

Hello everyone, old and new.

It's that time again – the start of the new academic year. The time where you have to dig out your red pen for marking, buy a new book/pillow for seminars and remember to go to the shop at 10am to guarantee yourself a lunch.

It also means lots of new people and hence our yearly postgrad get-to-know pub evening. This is a chance for all the new first year Phd and masters students to meet and greet the old folk about the department, while we scare the bejezus out of them with made-up postgrad horror stories.

This year we shall be meeting on Thursday (2nd Oct) at the Crystal Palace pub, from 7:30pm. A map of where it is, can be found on the link below:

<http://maps.google.co.uk/maps?&q=crystal+palace,+bath>

The place is quite easy to find, just take the first right before HMV, along the main high street (walking away from the train station), carry on to the end of the small street and then take a left and you should see it.

For those of you that are still unsure of your bearings, I shall be in the parade bar for a "pre-match" drink from 6-7 and then we can walk or take the bus down into town. Please let me know if you intend to go to the parade beforehand.

Hope to see most of you on thursday, especially the new folk!

Ray

2 October

Good morning (to those that are actually up)!. This is just a quick reminder about the pub evening tonight, at the Crystal Palace, from 7.30.

Apparently some of the new students didn't receive my original email, so hopefully they've now been added to the mailing list. Apologies for the short notice for those that are hearing about this for the first time. Details of tonight are in the original email below.

Please do spread the word about it, in case people still haven't been added to the mailing list.

Hope to see you all tonight!

Ray

10 October

It's Friday and the sun is actually shining! What better way to celebrate this fact than to spend it with some er mathematicians...

For the new folk about the town, Friday's are our usual get together in the parade bar, whether you like an alcoholic drink or not. We meet in the parade bar around 5:30, after the Landscape seminars or if you're like me, when the shakes get so bad you can't do anything else.

So if you're a new postgrad, please come along and meet the rest of us, especially if you missed the pub evening last week. This is also a good chance for all the young 'uns to show off their drinking prowess to us old folk, by being able to actually drink more than half a pint!

Hope to actually see some people out for a change!

Ray

ps for those that care (which I'm not one of them), there's not really any big birth/death days today...

24 October

It's Friday and the sun is actually shining! What better way to celebrate this fact than to... oh hang on I've done that one already.

Anyway, you should all know the score by now. Friday = Parade Bar evening.

After last weeks threats to those that didnt turn up, I shall be giving people one last chance to attend this week and cross themselves off the hitlist. Though that's partly due to the fact that Matt has been recovering after capping himself for not turning up last week...

The threats are serious and the Rottweiler really has some nasty punishments. So if you dont want to be regaled in long tales about how Forest were once the greatest team on the planet, or the brick-by-brick history of Trent Bridge, then you better come along. Though having said that, you might get that anyway if you do attend...

So if you fancy celebrating Wayne Rooneys birthday (or even Jackie McNamara if you're that way inclined), then I shall see you around 5:30.

Ray

31 October

If there's something strange
in your neighborhood
Who ya gonna call?
MATHSBUSTERS

If there's something weird
and it don't look good
Who ya gonna call?
MATHSBUSTERS

I ain't afraid of no Maths

Yeah I know that was rubbish but its been another long week...
If you didnt know already, today is the one day of the year where
your work isn't the only scary thing that faces you and where I
can go out and not look out of place.

Come along to the parade this evening for some trick and treats
(Matt will get his batteries out while you have a drink). Feel
free to come even if you're not one of those going to the cinema
tonight (I'm not going either).

Suppose I should mention again that it is Weierstrass's Birthday
and Harry Houdini's deathday, if that floats your boat and will
swing it for you.

See you around 5:30ish

Ray

7 November

This week some of you may have heard lots of whining sounds followed by large bangs. No I don't mean the fireworks, I mean those of you in Eastwood that have had to put up with my frustrations whilst attempting to finish my writing up.

I received a nice parcel this morning. It was some rubber wall-paper and a nice white jacket. I thought, wow my house can get a bit cold and needs better insulating. Then someone pointed out the real purpose...

Anyway its friday and parade drinks day.

I've heard on the grapevine (I risk life and limb to climb thin vines to bring you the latest gossip) that it is Mikhail's last day today. I think, though I'm probably wrong on this, that he was planning on attending this evening, so please come along to say your farewells and whatnot.

This week there are absolutely no worthwhile mathematicians born on this day. In fact anyone born today has been doomed to mathematical failure. However today is the birthday of one of my childhood heroes, John Barnes *swoon*.

I shall maybe go early (about 4:30-5:00) cause I really need a drink after this week. Otherwise its a Landscapes day and people will be heading off straight after that.

See you there!

Ray

14 November

WAHOOOOOOOOOOOO!!!! YIPEEEEEEEEE!!! GET IN!
HAAAAAVE IT!!!

Those are some of the more printable words that could be heard from my office when I realised it was Friday today.

The expletives that left my mouth after I submitted my thesis, a very short while ago, are banned from print altogether.

I shall be heading off to the parade earlier than normal. About 4:30–5:00, if anyone wants to join me. I certainly need a drink and its been absolutely ages since ive had more than a couple...*ahem*

Anyway dont expect any birthdays today (i'm sure someone will fill you in), cause I'm knackered and just about to pass out at my kdjfhdfhfs/09weuf7i4sjklw0[

28 November

I don't feel as if I know you

You take up all my time

The days are long and the night will throw you away
Cos the sun don't shine Nobody ever mentions the weather, can make
or break your day

Nobody ever seems to remember life is a game we play

We live in the shadows and we had the chance and threw it away
And it's never gonna be the same Cos the years are following
by like the rain And it's never gonna be the same 'Til the life I
knew comes to my house and says Hello

Hello!

Hello!

Hello!

Hello!

It's good to be back

Yes, just like the Austrian Oak, I have returned. I bet you all
missed me. You do actually remember me don't you?

It seems that this place has been falling down, in my absence.
There wasn't even a proper Parade drinks last Friday. Disgrace-
ful. Anyway, I'm back to right those wrongs and will need a
drink or two to make up for missing out last week.

This week we shall also be raising a glass in memory of Fermi
who died 54 years ago.

See you in the parade!

a slightly less stressed Ray

5 December

Hi, I'm Ray Fernandes. You may remember me from such emails as PSS reminder.

With the prospect of winter fast approaching, why not come down to the parade bar to warm yourself up with a pint, a coffee or even a glass of water. This week scientists officially proved that being in the Parade Bar on a Friday evening is much warmer than standing outside freezing your knackers off. Aren't those scientists clever. They also proved that the Parade Bar is 31.738% more fun than anything else on a Friday evening. You can't argue with that, can you?

This week we have a bumper celebration with the birthdays of Painlevé and Heisenberg amongst others, as well as the anniversary of Stirling's death. Away from mathematics, we also have the birthdays of Eddie "the Eagle" Edwards and Ronnie "the Rocket" O'Sullivan.

So why don't you come along to the parade bar for a friendly chat and unwind after the weeks erm hard(?) work. If enough people turn up I might not even pester you next week, to come along to the parade bar for drinks...

See you there

Ray

Photos of the *Aftermath*



The Bathampton Challenge



From A...



... to Z



Parade Style



Maths Pub Athletics Championships



Chiquito before Bowling



Maths Christmas Party



Maths Postgraduate Xmas Party

Part II

2009

9 Jan

Dear all,

Happy New Year!

I hope you're all refreshed after the holiday, raring to go on a whole new year of maths. Woo hoo!

Anyway, Ray has decamped and left us to organise Drinks in the Parade all on our own. So here goes:

Drinks!

In the Parade!

Today!

5.30pm!

Come along, it'll be fun.

And it's Ramanujam's birthday. Unfortunately not Ramanujan, who was much more fun (probably). And yesterday was Stephen Hawking's birthday. If you remind me I might tell you the story about when I met Stephen Hawking. It's great! (Disclaimer: actually it's not very interesting at all.)

In other news, check out

<http://online.wsj.com/article/SB123119236117055127.html>

Glad I'm not a statistician. 3rd! Ha! Rubbish!

See you later,

Matt

16 January

Dear all,

Have you ever wondered....

Which is worth more: one hundred million pounds, five hundred quintillion Zimbabwean dollars, or Kak?

Who gives a dink about an Oxford comma?

Do unrelated noun-noun combos make for good band names?

Has David Hockney ever met Blue?

What happened to the January postgrad away day?

Will Drinks in the Parade ever be as good again without Bruce?

If so, why not come on down to the Parade Bar at around 5.30pm, where we'll be discussing these questions and more.

See you there!

Matt

PS Best birthday I could find for today was Gronwall, of Gronwall's Lemma fame. And comedy Dutchman Martin Jol.

Pub Evening Thursday (29 January)

Hello!

Yes its been a while and I can see that there's a lot of disappointment, as you all thought you'd finally got rid of me and my pesky emails. However, just like a bad smell, I'm still lingering around.

Anyway, following on from the succesful pub evening at the start of last term we were considering on holding the next one this Thursday (time and place to be decided, but will be in the city centre). This is a good chance to catch up with everyone, especially those that can't make the parade on Friday's. There aren't many social opportunities around the department, so please show your face and get to know everyone. Everyone welcome, whether you drink alcohol or not, or whether you're a postdoc, Phd or Master's student. The more the merrier!

Due to the short notice, we will need to see if we have enough numbers to make it viable, so please, please let me know before tomorrow afternoon whether

- a) you're willing to turn up on Thursday
- b) you want to come but would prefer a different day (please specify dates)

otherwise we will have to cancel it. Plus it's Dave Miller's birthday and while he may even decide he doesn't want to come along, hopefully he can guilt you into celebrating his birthday

anyway. Also anyone that turns will be entitled to a free drink¹ from me!

In a further attempt to stabilise Bath's economy during this recession and to stop some of Bath's well loved drinking establishments from going under, Geoff has been thinking of a Pub Golf (or some variation) evening at some point. For those that don't know what pub golf is, it basically involves getting slightly tipsy at various public houses (NOT seeing who can chip a shot glass through a pub window into a wheely bin, although someone should create that game). Obviously this will only appeal to a certain number of you, but it should be a good laugh. Again everyone welcome, whether you just want to turn up for a short while and laugh at the rest of us or subject your liver to the equivalent of 20 rounds of UFC. This probably won't happen for a few weeks yet, but let either myself or Geoff know whether this interests you and what dates you're available.

Hope to see you all on Thursday!

Ray and Geoff (not under employment of the local breweries, honest!)

1. Size of drink not specified and may include water and not much in the way of anything else

Pub Evening Thursday (continued)

Thanks to all those that replied to the email I sent yesterday.

We have decided to carry on with tomorrow evening, for a meet up over the beverage of your choice.

The plan is to meet up at the Crystal Palace pub (same venue as October) at around 8pm. To mix things up, we will be moving on to the Cellar Bar close by, at about 9:30pm, so check your watch if you intend to come late! Please note the Cellar bar is the one on York Street underneath the Ale House and NOT the Porter Cellar Bar. I've attached a map of all the pubs (hopefully correctly annotated!) if you're unsure, or don't know Bath very well.

Just to be even more awkward, a couple of us will be heading off to the Wetherspoons by the Odeon cinema, for a pre-drink drink at around 7. Please let me know if you intend to meet us there.

Unfortunately I most likely won't be at university to walk down with people. If anyone is around and wants to volunteer, then please do so. Otherwise if you're still unsure on where you're going then let me know and I can maybe arrange to meet you at a more familiar location in town.

Hope to see many of you there tomorrow, feel free to turn up for however long you want. You should however come along if only to make Dave feel loved on his birthday, because he's not going to any other day of the year...

Ray and Geoff



13 February

Dear all,

Fed up after a whole week of hard graft with no snow days?
Come to Drinks in the Parade and celebrate the start of the weekend!

Worried about climate change and the state of the environment?
Come to Drinks in the Parade, where the large number of people in one room will make heating more cost-effective!

Stressed out by the thought of getting your thesis/paper/dissertation finished by March/September/June? Come to Drinks in the Parade, where our motto is “deadlines, schmedlines”!

Scared that it's Friday the 13th and something bad is going to happen to you? Come to Drinks in the Parade, where something bad will probably happen to Ray instead!

Afraid that no-one will remember Dirichlet's birthday? Come to Drinks in the Parade, where we'll remember Dirichlet's birthday!

See you there, 5.30pm.

Matt

PS Upset at the standard/lack of cricket in the West Indies?
Unfortunately Drinks in the Parade can't do anything about that. But come to Drinks in the Parade to drown your sorrows!

Pub Golf (20 February)

Here it is, finally the news you've all been waiting eagerly for... (and no it's not the news I've left, you'll have to withhold the wild celebrations for a while still). The date for the inaugural University of Bath, Maths, Postdoc and Postgrad, Pub Golf Tournament, has been decided and will be held on Friday 20th February.

For those that haven't a clue, the concept for Pub Golf is simple. Consume your drink in as little go's as possible. Just like a golf course, each drink will have a "par", meaning how many sips you should be aiming to take and scores will be based on that. Naturally we will not be doing the full 18 holes/pubs, but will be doing the shortened 9 hole course.

The plan is to maybe start at the parade bar, at the usual time, for the first drink and then head into town from there. For those wishing to participate but don't like a tippie, then a soft drink version will also be in place. Also if you can't make the full night there is a possibility that we will be sending out an itinerary of pubs at which we will be at, so you can come and laugh at us, though this is not yet decided.

Rules and further details are currently drawn up by tournament organiser Mr Littler and will be clarified sometime next week. So if you want any specific rules included (I'm still pushing the one where I can drink at any pace and win automatically), feel free to send an unmarked brown envelope with plenty of cash and I'm sure we may possibly considerate it. Possibly.

Let me know if you are considering attending at any point in the night, so we can keep track of numbers and who wants to come! Should be a good laugh whether you participate or not.

Tiger Woods & John Daly (aka Ray & Geoff)

Disclaimer: Ray and Geoff do not in any way encourage irresponsible drinking. We are in no way responsible for any ill-effects caused by the consumption of alcohol, or for lemonade coming out of your nose because you've drunk it too quickly. We are of course far too preoccupied with getting drunk ourselves to care about trying to get others drunk.

Pub Golf - Friday

After much wrangling with golf's R&A, Geoff has finally agreed with rules for the maths pub golf, on Friday 20th February.

The enclosed attachment is the scorecard for the evening, which includes rules and the list of pubs and times for the evening. We will start at the parade bar at the usual time of 5:30 (turn up on time as we will be starting pretty sharpish) and finish at the huntsman at approx 10:15 (full times at the end of the email), where we will stay for further drinks (for those that can take it), as it serves till 1:45am. People are obviously welcome to come along with us at any point in the night, so please do come and laugh at the rest of us. For anyone not wanting to drink alcohol either, then soft drinks are available as well, so you have no excuse.

Please note that we will NOT be stopping for food at any point during the night. Obviously drinking without eating is a recipe for disaster... so please make sure you eat something before 5:30, either as a very large lunch or something just before 5:30.

For each pub there is a designated drink and volume of drink. Each golfer must consume that drink in as little attempts as possible. This does not necessarily mean opening your throat and pouring it down in 2 seconds! Each attempt can take as long as you want as long as you don't stop drinking. In theory you can spend hours drinking and still get a "hole in one" - though most probably we'll have left you behind in the pub... The par on the scorecard reflects how many attempts you should be aiming for. If you don't like the specific drink, then you may

replace it for another (though the same volume), with a 3 shot penalty. Also 10 shot penalties apply to any holes that aren't completed.

Whilst I'm sure some people will be trying to get the best score possible, this is all just a bit of fun, so if you feel like you're struggling, don't push yourself to be competitive (I need to tell myself this). Remember there's always the soft drink option or just miss the hole. Its just a laugh and at the end of the day the scorecards won't mean anything (especially as geoff will win anyway...). Expect some scores to be monstrously high, especially mine!

Remember also when buying your drink, not to take a sip, as that will count as a shot! Even if you're trying to remove the head off a beer as that's the equivalent of ripping out a chunk of turf to get a better lie for your ball.

If you haven't already let us know of your intention to turn up at some point in the evening (whether its for all 9 holes or just for a couple), please do so. Scorecards will most likely be printed off on the day for you, so don't worry about that yourself. If you've any questions, then don't hesitate to contact us.

I hope that wasn't information overload and I think that's just about the most sensible email I've ever sent, so I'll finish on a song...

Too late, my time has come
Sends shivers down my spine, body's aching all the time
Goodbye everybody, I've got to go
Gotta leave you all behind and face the truth

Mama, ooooooooooh, I don't want to die
I sometimes wish I'd never been born at all

Hopefully see you there on Friday and best of luck golfers!! Remember drink sensibly!

A slightly apprehensive Ray and a very eager Geoff

Disclaimer: Ray and Geoff in absolutely no way condone the consumption of alcohol. We both think its horrible stuff. In fact we both fully endorse drinking camomile tea with a hint of raspberry, preferably sipped slowly in tiny teacups that you can't even fit your little finger through the handle.

Parade	-	5:30
Plug	-	6:15
Rat & Parrot	-	7:15
Flan O'Brians	-	7:35
Wetherspoons	-	8:10
Lamb & Lion	-	8:40
Crystal Palace	-	9:15
Cellar bar	-	9:45
Huntsman	-	10:15

27 February

Dear all,

Drinks in the Parade has been described as:

As cool as George Bush in a shell suit
As much fun as a group hug in a burns ward
As welcome as Bjork at a tinnitus convention
As much use as a solar-powered foghorn

However, it's Friday, and we're mathematicians, so what better offers have we got? Plus it's Joe Doob's birthday. Joe Doob is one of my many heroes. And it's Independence Day in both Lebanon and Dominica! What better excuse for a trip to the Parade?

See you there - around 5.30pm, after the Landscapes seminar.

Matt

6 March

Dear all,

Does tequila make you happy?

Does red red wine make you feel so fine?

Have you got your daddy's eyes? Was your daddy an alcoholic?

Are you the last of the big time drinkers?

Is there a tear in your beer?

Is there whiskey in your jar?

Did you hear it through the grapevine?

Well then, come along to Drinks in the Parade at 5.30pm. Be there, or be a rhombus which, when cut along either of its lines of reflectional symmetry, gives two identical right-angled triangles.

(Both non-alcoholic drinks and non-alcoholic song lyrics are available on request.)

Until 5.30,

Matt

(Yeah, I know the grapevine one was tenuous.)

13 March

Dear all,

Today, you may have noticed, is Friday the 13th. This being the second Friday the 13th in as many months, you may be getting fed up of all the bad luck. There is a solution to this: head to Drinks in the Parade, and the bad luck will stop. Guaranteed. Simple.

Also, tomorrow is Einstein's birthday. Although tomorrow isn't today, so you might think this is a poor excuse for heading to Drinks in the Parade, Einstein's birth did actually fall on a Friday, and no doubt Hermann and Pauline took young Albie along to Drinks in the Parade back in 1879 to celebrate his birth. In fact, rumour has it that that was the first ever Drinks in the Parade, falling as it did just three days after our very own Ray Fernandes had invented email.

See you there, 5.30.

Matt

St. Patrick's Day (17 March)

Top o' the morning to you,

Today is St. Patrick's Day and as a result, we thought it best if we headed into town for some pints of Guinness. So, if you fancy it, put on your greenest clothes and head on over to Wether-spoons at 7:30pm to try and earn yourself a hat! We may then move on from there (depending on crowdedness of bar and availability of hats) so drop me an email if you're planning on coming along later.

Come for the craic,
Geoff

P.S. Green clothes and Guinness drinking non-essential

27 March

Tick-tock, tick-tock, tick-tock.

Remember, remember the er 29th of March? This weekend finally sees us back into British Summer (that does seem like a bit of an oxymoron to me) Time. However it does mean losing a whole hour of your life (albeit temporarily), and trust me, at this age every second is precious! Indeed recent research has suggested that... erm, er declines...the...27...er...at...erm...brain? But it obviously hasn't affected me yet, so it can't be right.

It's also the end of term and possibly Nathan's (who has been here longer than me - so Jurassic times then) last parade drinks(?), so he will hopefully be out showing how the youngsters should be doing things, no doubt.

Last week, to my shame, I forgot to mention who were celebrating their birthdays. This week sees the birthdays of Quentin Tarantino and Mariah Carey. What better way to celebrate both than by cutting your own ears off...

Don't forget that all computing services will be down from 5:10 today, so remember to log off and you will have no excuse for not coming to the parade this week because of work!!

see you then

Ray (old father time)

20 March

Opal Fruits, Jif, Marathons, mullets, more than meets the eye, La Lights, heroes in a half shell, plastic lunch boxes and flasks, Granny's Garden, I pity the foo', doing the shake-and-vac, t-shirts that change colour with heat, spellcasting: D-I-S-M-I-S-S, purple shell suits, the Chicken Song, armadillos - smooth on the inside, crunchy on the outside!, Mr Miyagi, the screeches of your computer attempting (and failing) to load a tape, Screech, undercuts, uppercuts, the power of greyskull, Um Bongo, Hammer-time, Liverpool winning the league, white dog poo, ACTUAL SUN!!!

Isn't nostalgia great? Since the "Rottweiler" is away, this week sees an old skool retro Friday, with me doing the emails again and some good weather to boot as well!

Place: Parade Bar.

Time: 5:30pm (ish), just after the Landscape seminar.

Dress code: Tank tops.

Ray

Pub evening: Thurs (9 April)

To mark the last day at uni before easter and to make up for lack of parade drinks, there shall be a pub evening this Thursday in town.

insert long and unnecessary, but very humourous paragraphs

We will be meeting at the Crystal Palace at 8:30pm, before heading to the Huntsman nearby for 10:00pm. For those that wish to go down early, there will be some people meeting up in the Wetherspoons for some food (thursday = curry club as well).

Wetherspoons	18:30
Crystal Palace	20:30
Huntsman	22:00

More humourous anecdotes involving some eggstremely awful puns

Dave M. will no doubt be bringing his well worn fluffy pink bunny outfit, so feel free to dress up in your own.

All Welcome. Any queries should go to Geoff or myself.

Geoff and Ray (Easter beer hunt eggsperts)

24 April

Dear all,

It's back! You know you've missed it. That's right, Drinks in the Parade returns today at 5.30pm(ish)!

As you probably know, today is the 3193rd anniversary of the Greeks entering Troy via the now cliché Trojan horse. In tribute, Dave will be reading the Aeneid in full aloud in the style of Pato Banton. (Pato Banton always wrote in dactylic hexameter so it won't be hard to adapt.) This is not an event to be missed, so don't be late.

See you there,
Matt

Friday Drinks and Meal (1 May)

Mayday! Mayday! We haven't had drinks in ooooh a few days...

Yes its finally the first proper bank holiday weekend of the year and to celebrate the extra days worth of hangover rest, we are planning our next pub evening on Friday 1st May. So strap on your bells and ribbons and have a dance around the maypole.

Also to celebrate the passing of my viva, we shall be heading off for a curry at the Eastern Eye restaurant at 7:30pm (simply because it's big enough to fit lots of us in), for those of you that aren't as well rehearsed in the world of pubs.

PLEASE REPLY if you want to come out for the meal, so I can book a table. Let me know by the end of Wednesday afternoon, otherwise you are most likely going to be having a rat burger from the Mr D's van.

Everyone welcome, whether you know me or not, or whether you hate me or not. Partners, etc are all welcome too, just don't bring pets as they may end up as the main course. Also feel free to turn up at any point during the night. We should hopefully be at the Cellar Bar by 9:30pm, but that obviously may depend on how greedy some people are.

The schedule can be found below:

- 5:30ish - usual Parade drinks (though you may want to join us there earlier as we'll be leaving around 6:30...)
- 7:00 - Salamander
- 7:30 - Eastern Eye restaurant
- 9:30 - Cellar bar
- 10:30 - Huntsman (possibly)

<http://www.easterneye.com/>

Like I said, let me know if you intend to join us for the meal.

Ray and Geoff (in serious need of help)

ps I'll still be lurking around for a little while yet so you haven't got rid of me that easily.

1 May

Dear all,

Don't forget:

Landscapes talk: 4.15 (3WN 2.1)

Drinks in the Parade: 5.30

Then Ray's viva-passing celebrations:

Salamander: 7.00

Eastern Eye: 7.30

Cellar bar: 9.30

Huntsman: 10.30

If you want to come to the Eastern Eye and haven't yet told Ray, do so pronto (I guess the Eastern Eye will still be able to adapt to a change in numbers but I don't know, so don't rule out that rat burger from Mr D's just yet). You're welcome to turn up at any other point without warning!

Apparently today is "Love Day" in the Czech Republic. Make sure you show Ray some love.

See you there - wherever "there" is,
Matt

15 May

Dear all,

It's almost here. That thing you've been waiting all week for. You know, the really exciting thing, with, er, lots of people together in a room that's not your office, and some music and stuff, and people getting drunk and wishing the music would stop. Yes, that's right, it's the Eurovision Song Contest tomorrow! But first it's Drinks in the Parade, today, 5.30pm. Rumours that Terry Wogan has resigned from Eurovision just so that he doesn't miss out on the Parade action tonight may or may not be true. At least we know Graham Norton won't be there.

Also, I promise not to sing any ABBA songs.

See you there,

Matt

Bathampton Pub Challenge (24 May)

Dear all,

Do you, like us, feel that there aren't enough bank holiday pub challenges available?

If so, join us this Sunday (24th May) for the Bathampton Pub Challenge. We intend to start from the Curfew at midday and wind our way along the London Road and down Mill Lane stopping for half pints at each pub we come across until we reach the George at the entrance to Bathampton (for the whole route: <http://tinyurl.com/q29bae>). At this point we shall turn round and come back, having the other half of our pints in the same set of pubs until we reach the Curfew again whereupon we shall continue into town (still stopping for halves at every available pub) until time (or some other factor) stops us.

We plan to eat a light tea in the George and pick something up when we get back into town but we would suggest having a big breakfast before setting off!

The challenge, for the crazy amongst you, is to have a half in every pub. But for those who are sane, come along and enjoy the day out with whatever drinks you choose. Bathampton is a pretty little place on the river, so hopefully the weather will be good and make the day even more enjoyable - we might be able to replace some of the trek along London Road with some frolicking by the river on the way...

If you want to come along but not spend the whole day out, my mobile number is 07974993545; feel free to contact me during

the day to find out where we are.

We hope to see plenty of you there,
Geoff (and Matt)

22 May

This weekend sees the Spring Bank Holiday, the second bank holiday of May. Maybe you should celebrate the weekend by helping some suicidal ducklings, by catching them as they jump off a window ledge. Remember also there's the Bathampton pub challenge on Sunday. Whatever you do, it looks like it'll be a sunny one!

If I remember rightly, tomorrow is also Hug a Ginger day. So do your bit for those poor folk and give them a nice hug to make them feel "special". However, I have had a fruitless search at trying to confirm this on the internet, so my hugs may be reserved until I get definitive proof. I am still waiting for hug a short-arse day as well :(

So after what seems like a very hard week of doing nothing during those long invigilations, why not join us in the parade for a drink. I suppose those that have just finished their exams might have something to celebrate as well, though obviously not as much as those finishing their invigilations.

Right I'm off to claim a second rent on my bench fees. See you in the parade 5:30ish.

Ray

29 May

Dear all,

Happy at the end of the exams / invigilations? Happy that it's sunny and hot? Unhappy that you've been overlooked for the role of Doctor Who's new assistant?

Come along to Drinks in the Parade, where Ray will happily tell you what your "glass hold" says about your personality. (<http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/health/8073432.stm>)

I would bring along the legendary Flying Disc but it died an ugly death and I'm yet to buy another one despite the £2.99 maths postgrad replacement flying disc fund.

See you there, 5.30

Matt

5 June

Drinks in the parade are already underway.

Well done to the Maths football team who have won an unprecedented 10 out of 10 games this season to storm to the league title.

That is all

Ray

PS Don't use the ITbox as we've already cleaned up with 6 wins in a row.

A–Z pub challenge: Saturday 20th June

The powers that be seem to have declared that our last outing wasn't enough, and that we should proceed with yet another new way of making a fool of ourselves (well making a fool of me, which isn't difficult). So this Saturday we are taking it to the next level and are attempting to go to 26 different places each beginning with a different letter of the alphabet. As you can guess, I'm more scared than the prospect of being dangled in a dark pit full of tarantulas infected with swine flu, whilst having to listen to "the best" of the Cheeky Girls.

As always everyone is welcome at any point during the day, whether you're drinking or not, but of course due to the nature of these things it will be difficult to determine exactly where we will be. However we are aiming to be at certain points during the day for food or if you come inbetween, Geoff has kindly allowed anyone to contact him on 07974993545

Plans are still being formed, but we are likely to be starting at All Bar One for some breakfast at 11. We shall be gone before 12 so please make sure you get there early if you want to do the full challenge.

After some drinks inbetween, we hope to make lunch at the Jamuna restaurant (which happens to be next to all bar one) just before 2:30. If you plan to attend this lunch, please make sure you let me know so we can book a table.

Finally, if things go to plan, we shall end up in the Raven for dinner at around 7.

Like I said, people can come and go as you wish, but just make sure you let me know asap if you plan on eating lunch with us. Expect an email with further details and any alterations, later in the week.

Ray and Geoff and all those that contributed a letter (hoping its easy as ABC)

ps if anyone can suggest any letters for drinking establishments (incl restaurants, hotels etc), then feel free to do so. We're stumped with Z and if you've alternatives for D,E,I,Q,U,X then we'll be happy.

Drinks in the Parade (and an alphabet of others) (19 June)

Hi,

It's a Friday. There's Parade drinking to be had. More of that later.

We had a request for the full list of venues for tomorrow's alphabet social. So, here goes:

All Bar One (11am-midday)

Belushi's

Coeur De Lion

Dukes Hotel

Eastern Eye

Flan O'Briens

Grapes

Huntsman

Il Tocco D'Italia

Jamuna (2:30pm)

King's Arms

Lamb and Lion

Metropolitan

New Inn

O'Neill's

Porter

Queensberry Hotel

Raven (7pm)

Salamander

Trinity

Ustinov
Volunteer Rifleman's Arms
Wetherspoons
XL (maybe)
Ye Olde Farmhouse
Z ???

The times are approximate but are by the places we intend to eat. If you would like to join us for lunch at Jamuna, please email back asap as we need to book ahead.

Feel free to join us for as much or as little of the day as you like whether you intend to drink or not. If you want to find out where we are, contact me on 07974993545.

Now, back to this evening. According to psychologists:

The Happiness Formula - $O + (NxS) + Cpm/T + He$

indicates that today, June 19th, is the happiest day of the year; so come along and enjoy all the good feeling in the Parade bar at 5:30pm.

According to rumours heard on the grapevine, the physicists are also planning on setting up their own drinks in the parade, so let's not be outdone by these Parade drinking novices and let's turn out in force!

Hope to see many of you there,
Geoff

24 July

Have you run out of Tamiflu? Were you invited to the South Korean parliament and have the bruises to prove it? Did you pull an all-nighter to queue up for the new newcastle deckchair kit, only to realise no-one actually wants it? Have you spent a whole week doing maths? If so, maybe you should head down to the parade bar, and join us at 5pm, to unwind after the week's ordeals.

Yes we're back again, by popular demand², for another installment of Friday Parade Drinks!

This Friday's quiz question is: How many doughnuts can Keith Chegwin eat without licking his lips?

Answers on a postcard to the usual address.

The answer to last weeks question was: contrafibularities
Who would have thunk it eh?

See you in the Parade

Ray (unwinding after yet another tough week of work)

2. me being popular and demanding it.

31 July

Short email this week. Yes amazingly we have 3 weeks in a row of Parade Drinks.

Since no-one got the correct answer to last week's question we have another jackpot rollover.

This Friday's quiz question is: Where's the summer gone?
As ever answers on a postcard to the usual address.

Last week's answer was: 52
The greedy pig.

See you there as usual, for drinks in the Parade from 5:30ish

Ray

14 August

Dear all,

Waaaaaagh!

It's Friday!

Last week we decided that, as we had completed a whole month of Drinkses in the Parades, we should celebrate. We decided to celebrate this week, by going to the Parade! Wooooo!

Rumours that Barack Obama is soon to ringfence £400 billion to safeguard free beer for all are yet to be confirmed - but there will at least be cheap happy hour drinks (and maybe the odd lecherous Open University mature student if you're really up for a good time).

See you there,
Matt

Disclaimer: Neither me nor my computer encourages or condones free alcohol or lecherous middle aged men.

21 August

This is 21, Eastwood Avenue.

And this is Ray, the PhD student who leads an exciting double life. For when the clock hits 5.30 on Friday, an amazing transformation occurs. Ray is...

Dah dah dah dah daaaaah dah dah...

PARADE MAN!!!

Ever alert for the call to action!

Come along to the Parade today to see Parade Man in action. And to celebrate the birthdays of both Augustin-Louis Cauchy (of “Why did the mathematician call his dog Cauchy?” fame - apparently he was also quite good at analysis) and, more importantly, our very own Susan Doshi.

See you there,
Matt

28 August

Is it me or has the summer gone by quicker than Usain Bolt with a jetpack? Well Autumn may be fast approaching and the sun disappearing, but there's one thing you can rely on and that's drinks in the parade, back again for the 500th³ time!

Today would have marked the 984th birthday of the Emperor Go-Reizei of Japan. That's if he'd actually bothered to listen to his mum and eat his greens, instead of pigging out on McDonalds. Now if that isn't something to celebrate, I don't know what is.

Hope you all enjoy the last bank holiday before xmas and don't forget the uni is shut on Tuesday!

See you in the parade

Ray (welcoming the much needed extended weekend)

3. to the nearest 500.

4 September

DEAR SIR OR MADAM

URGENT AND CONFIDENTIAL BUSINESS PROPOSAL

I AM MATT ROBERTS, WIDOW OF THE LATE NIGERIAN HEAD OF STATE, GEN. PARADI BARR. AFTER HE DEATH OF MY HUSBAND WHO DIED MYSTERIOUSLY AS A RESULT OF CARDIAC ARREST, I WAS INFORMED BY OUR LAWYER, BELLO GAMBARI THAT, MY HUSBAND WHO AT THAT TIME WAS THE PRESIDENT OF NIGERIA, CALLED HIM AND CONDUCTED HIM ROUND HIS APARTMENT AND SHOWED HIM FOUR METAL BOXES CONTAINING MONEY ALL IN FOREIGN EXCHANGE AND HE EQUALLY MADE HIM BELIEVE THAT THOSE BOXES ARE FOR ONWARD TRANSFER TO HIS OVERSEAS COUNTERPART FOR PERSONAL INVESTMENT.

I HAVE SUCCEEDED IN CARRYING THE FOUR METAL BOXES OUT OF THE COUNTRY, WITH THE AID OF SOME TOP GOVERNMENT OFFICIAL, WHO STILL SHOW SYMPATHY TO MY FAMILY, TO A NEIGHBOURING COUNTRY (ACCRA-GHANA) TO BE PRECISE. I PRAY YOU WOULD HELP US IN GETTING THIS MONEY TRANSFERRED OVER TO YOUR COUNTRY.

YOU CAN CONTACT ME THROUGH COMING TO THE PARADE BAR AT 5.30PM.

THANKS AND BEST REGARD

MRS. MATT ROBERTS

11 September

Dear all,

Drinks in the Parade continues unabated this week, although given that summer seems to have burst back into life like a nonagenarian on speed, perhaps we will instead be having Drinks by the Lake. And playing frisbee (upgraded from flying disc!) where there aren't any cars - or windows - to spoil our fun.

See you there,

Matt

18 September

Dear all,

I remember when Parade drinks was young
Ray and Geoffrey had so much fun
Supping pints and playing pool
Had an office in Norwood and Ray had a room

But the biggest kick I ever got
Was doing a thing called a sherbet vodka shot
While the other kids were rocking round the clock
Tom and Fynn they were drinking those sherbet vodka shots

Well!
Sherbet vodka
Is something shocking
When your tongue just can't keep still
I never knew me a better drink and I guess I never will!

Oh!
Lordy mama
Those Friday nights
When Ray he were those hot pants tight and
Sherbet vodka was ou-ou-out of si-igh-igh-igh-igh-ight

Dooo
Doo doo doo doo doo
Doo doo doo doo doo
Doo doo doo doo doo

Dooo

Doo doo doo doo doo
Doo doo doo doo doo...

See you there,
Matt

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Y2Ta0qCG8No&feature=related>

Arthur Guinness Day, Thursday and Maths Pub Athletics Championships (24–26 September)

Hello there

I would like to bring to your attention to plans for two social events taking part this week, so please bear with me about the length of this email!

To summarise the main point of this email the happenings of this week will be:

Thursday 16:00: Meet in Wetherspoons to start celebrations of Arthur Guinness Day, before moving on.

Friday 17:30: Opening ceremony, to be held in the Parade Bar, for the Maths Pub Athletics Championships, and the start of some events.

Saturday 13:00: Start in Wetherspoons for the main days events for the Maths Pub Athletics Championships.

All welcome.

Firstly, for those old folk like me, you might remember way back on 24th September 1759, when a young man named Arthur Guinness decided to set up his own brewery in Dublin. This was a big moment in history and the beer he created is still being drunk to this day by millions of Sergey's across the world. To celebrate the 250th anniversary, there will be worldwide celebrations and promotions, with a toast to Arthur due at 17:59.

We shall be joining in the celebrations tomorrow (mainly to

get the free goodies) and will be meeting in Wetherspoons from 4pm. Obviously a lot of you can't make it that early, and as we are definitely moving on from there at some point (where and when we're not sure yet), if you would like to join us later on, let either myself or Geoff know so we can pass on our phone numbers. Whatever you end up doing, remember to stop at 17:59 and raise a glass of that well known drink Arthur's, to Arthur Guinness.

And now on to the main event of the week. The Maths Pub Athletics schedule has been finalised and may be found below. To make sure we have enough time to complete all the events, some events will be held during Drinks in the Parade™ on the Friday, whilst others will be held across both Friday and Saturday. Details of what each event entails may also be found at the end. The Saturday will start at 12:00pm for brunch for those wishing to eat out, and the first event will start at 1pm.

As with all our social events, you do not have to be an alcoholic to participate or turn up to watch! Anyone is welcome at any point in the day, whether you want to watch or take part. If anyone who doesn't want to take part, but would like to come along, we would be grateful for a volunteer timekeeper/judge to keep a track of things!

Hope to see lots of athletes and spectators this weekend

ps if anyone knows how to get hold of lots of cheap plastic shot glasses, let me know!

Friday Events

100m Parade Bar	18:00
Long Jump Parade Bar	18:30*
300m Steeplechase Parade Bar	19:15

Saturday Events

FOOD Wetherspoons	12:00
400m Hurdles Wetherspoons	13:00
Hammer Boater	14:00
110m Hurdles Metropolitan	15:00
800m Griffin	16:00
Javelin Vodka Revolution	17:00
400m Lamb & Lion	18:00
FOOD Lamb & Lion	
Shot Putt Lamb & Lion	19:15
Pole Vault Wetherspoons	20:00
Triple Jump Wetherspoons	20:45
4×100m Cork	21:45
4×400m Crystal Palace	22:30

Weekend Events

High Jump
Discus

Event Descriptions

High Jump: Bet how many shots of beer you can consume in 15 seconds. You have 3 attempts for each bet you make, but must be able to complete your attempt before you can increase your bet.

Discuss: Drink a frisbee full of beer (approx 1.5 pints) through a single straw, in the quickest time possible (time trial). You have up to 3 attempts, over the course of the two days.

100m: Drink a bottle of alcopop in the quickest time possible (race).

Long Jump: Drink a Long Island Iced Tea through a straw (race). *Note that this event depends on finding a suitable place that serves this drink.

300m Steeplechase: Drink 3 pints in the quickest time possible, with two water hazards of half a pint of water each, inbetween the beer/cider (race).

400m Hurdles: Drink a pint with 3 shots of apple sourz drunk inbetween (race).

Hammer: Drink half a pint, spin round 3 times, then run to a specified location, where you will have to drink another half pint (time trial).

110m Hurdles: Drink 10 shots of beer (race).

800m: Drink 2 pints (race).

Javelin: Drink a stick (6 shots) of flavoured shots (race).

400m: Drink a pint (race).

Shot Putt: Drink a Jagerbomb (race).

Pole Vault: Strawpedo a bottle of Koppaberg (race).

Triple Jump: Drink half a pint, a shot of 30%+ alcohol, alcopop (race).

4x100m: Be the first team to finish drinking an alcopop each (race). The team member proceeding you must finish their drink before you can start yours. Team sizes will depend on how many participate.

4x400: Be the first team to finish drinking a pint each (race). The team member proceeding you must finish their drink before you can start yours. Team sizes will depend on how many participate.

25 September

Dear all,

Do you have an aptitude for athletics? A talent for the triple jump? Is your forte for the 400m? Are you made of the right stuff for the relay? Have you got an understanding for the 'urdles (sorry)?

No, me neither. That's why I'm doing a maths PhD.

I didn't read Ray's whole email but I doubt they have a medal for "person who can drink a pint in the time closest to half an hour", so that's my chances gone. But hey, I'll be in the Parade tonight anyway.

See you there,
Matt

2 October

Hellllooooooooooooooooooooooooooooo!!!

So, it's a new year, and a new me. Yes, I've decided to turn over a new leaf: I'm not going to laugh at Ray any more, hotpants or not.

New postgrads and postdocs! Woo! Hello. You get one of these emails most weeks, on a Friday, trying to persuade you to come to the Parade bar for a drink (or two...) after work, by virtue of obscure in-jokes and references to dead mathematicians / pro wrestling / BBC news stories / etc. We've heard that this week you already have something or other organized (you're welcome to come along if we heard wrong though), but next week you have no excuse.

So, what obscure in-jokes do I have for you this week? Well, inspired by Martin Reed's introductory tutorial "human bingo", I've lovingly produced a "postgrad bingo" sheet - attached. Note that it's actually closer to Blockbusters than bingo, but the freshers aren't old enough to remember Blockbusters (I asked and they thought it was a DVD rental shop). And it's harder to draw hexagons than rectangles in Word.

In summary: take that bra off your face⁴ and come to the Parade bar! 5.30pm ish. All welcome.

See you there,
Matt

4. <http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/sci/tech/8285380.stm>

Pub Evening Tuesday 6th October: Crystal Palace

Hello everyone

This is just to let you know that it's that time of the year again when the new folk come in and the musical chairs starts, and ends up with some poor sucker without a seat (i.e. me). It also means that's it's time for the first pub evening of the year, to get to know all the new PhD and Masters students.

Following on from last years successful pub evenings, we will once again be heading off to the Crystal Palace pub. This year we will be meeting on Tuesday 6th October, and will be meeting there from 7:30pm. For those that don't know where it is, let me know and I'll send directions, but I'm sure some of us will be meeting at some point on campus, and head down from there. Details of that will be sent in a brief reminder next Tuesday.

Please do attend, whatever year you are in, as it's a great way to meet your fellow students and all the people in the department you will be working with, rather than only getting to know the people in your office. Everyone is welcome, whether you turn up for a short while, or whether you drink or not. Could you also spread the word please, as I know from past years that not everyone might be on the mailing lists yet.

Ok, new people carry on reading, while everyone else, it's your choice (if you haven't already stopped reading)....

Firstly I would like to welcome you all to life as a University of Bath postgrad student. I'm sure you feel at home very quickly

and I wish you all the best in the time you spend here.

For those that don't know me, I'm the resident alcoholic/nutjob, and since last years similar email, I've probably acquired the titles of lurker and masochist, among others. As the unofficial social organiser, I'm sure you will be hearing from me at some point about some crazy events.

Also, if you were thinking about leaving campus early on Friday, then I would implore you to think again. Every Friday evening, postgrads (and postdocs) from the department head off to the university Parade Bar for a couple of drinks - both alcoholic or non-alcoholic. Since Matt "the Rottweiler" Roberts has now taken over the emails, I'm sure he will explain it better than me tomorrow and be more persuasive than me. He may even resort to sending out Geoff "the Leviathan" Littler to help with his persuasion and you really don't want things to go that far. But of course everyone knows that regular parade drinks attendance is the only sure way to successfully get your Masters/PhD anyway.

I look forward to meeting you all and hope to see you on Friday and Tuesday

Ray (sending "quality" emails since 2005)

ps Thanks to all that attended the pub athletics last weekend (spectators or participants)! Was a great weekend.

Pub Evening Reminder: Crystal Palace 7:30pm

hello there new folk and old

Just to remind you about the welcome to postgrad life pub evening taking place tonight. We will be meeting at the Crystal Palace from 7:30pm onwards. It should be easy to spot us as we will (hopefully!) be the largest (and most probably scariest looking) group there.

For those that don't know where they're going, or want a pre-match drink, some of us will be meeting in the parade bar on campus for food (Crystal Palace also does food), between 6pm and 7pm, and then heading into town from there. If you don't know what any of us look like, then let me know and I'll arrange to meet somewhere obvious, or give a description or something.

Remember to remind people in your office about this, in case they haven't been added to the mailing list yet.

Both the Rottweiler and the Leviathan will be about tonight enforcing attendance, so please make sure you do turn up, as you have to. Valid excuses for non-attendance must be submitted and ratified by midday, otherwise suspension of bench fees will ensue, as well as the usual knee-capping.

Looking forward to seeing all of you tonight

Andi

By the way

By the way, the Crystal Palace is here: <http://tinyurl.com/y8b3cdw>

Matt

9 October

Dear all,

Happy birthday to you,

Happy birthday to you,

Happy birthday dear Heinrich Schutz, King Charles X of France,
BRIAN BLESSED (<http://tinyurl.com/52ldpe>), John Lennon,
John Entwistle, Sharon Osbourne, David Cameron, Eddie Guer-
rero, PJ Harvey, Mark Viduka (<http://tinyurl.com/d7yrb3>), Nicky
Westlife and Drinks in the Parade,

Happy birthday to you!

Yes, that's right folks. It's two years (to the nearest Friday) since the first ever Drinks in the Parade! Word has it that Ray's bringing a cake (if you have any candles please bring them along), Fynn's going to sing Happy Birthday in German and James is going to dance around a spoon. Now if I can just get one of the barmaids to dress up as Marilyn Monroe...

Now. Apparently some of the new postgrads weren't on the list last week. If you're still not on the list but by some miracle are reading this email, then please send your name and email address on a postcard to the usual address:

Drinks in the Parade,
Department of Mathematical Sciences,
University of Bath
BA2 7AY

and hopefully they'll be confused enough in the office to come and find you and ask you what's going on and you can tell them

what the problem is. Or you could just go and complain loudly near someone official-looking.

So, again, just in case you missed the point of this email (“in-vraisemblable!” I hear you cry) - come to the Parade bar! 5.30pm ish!

See you there!

Matt!

16 October

Aiiiiight bros!

True dat, true dat. Tell u what, peeps is goin to Parade Bar round half 5. Shud be hella dope. I is moked afta teh weeks work yeh. Fo shizzle. Us bros will be da blenders not da players rite. Dat's how u no, dat's how u no innit.

Laterz,

Matt

23 October

My daaaarlings!

What a vicious cloud that is I see beyond my tiny pane of wax-stained glass. Not becoming of a Friday afternoon at all. Especially such a Friday as this, when, as our good friend Steven has announced, the remarkable chap has only gone and relinquished his hold upon this student life by passing his viva voce! You will no doubt be delighted to hear that a certain Mr Jason Cook (also known well by many of you I'm sure) did the same yesterday.

So, what is this "list" of which Steven speaks? Why else might one drag oneself along to the Parade bar? Well, today is, of course, the birthday of the wonderful Piers Bohl - first to prove Brouwer's fixed point theorem (though why said theorem might be named after that reprehensible fellow is beyond me - and after Bohl proved it too!) and not to be confused with physicist (pah!) Niels Bohr. Geoffrey "loquacious" Littler has promised me personally that he will buy a glass of port for the most thrilling proof of that theorem heard tonight. It is, what's more, the birthday of both the hilarious Jimmy Bullard and the much talked upon Apple iPod - not to mention it being, last but certainly - certainly! - not least, Phra Bat Somdet Phra Poramintharamaha Chulalongkorn Phra Chunla Chom Klao Chao Yu Hua day. And where would we be without Phra Bat Somdet Phra Poramintharamaha Chulalongkorn Phra Chunla Chom Klao Chao Yu Hua?

See you there, 5pm ish,
Matt

30 October

Let us go then, you and I,
When the evening is spread out against the sky
Like an undergrad lain drunk upon a table;
Let us go, across this half-deserted campus,
The lecturers will thank us.

For I have known them all already, known them all:-
Have known the fools, the bums, the asses,
I have measured out my life with pint glasses.

Though I have seen my chips [grown slightly cold] brought in
upon a platter
I am a postgrad - and here's no great matter;
I have seen the moment of my viva flicker,
And I have seen the external examiner hold my coat, and snicker,
And in short I was afraid.

I should have been a pair of ragged claws
Scuttling across the floors of silent seas.

And would it have been worth it, after all,
After the maths, the tutorials, the fees,
Among the postdocs, among some talk of you and me,
Would it have been worth while?

Let us go then, you and I,
When the evening is spread out against the sky
Oh, do not ask "What is it?"
Let us go and make our visit!

Parade bar, 5.30pm ish, celebrating the 49th anniversary of the

first
successful kidney transplant. See you there. Innit.

A Drunken Helot

PS Don't forget there's a Landscapes seminar at 4.15 - they're supposed to be suitable for a wide audience and everyone is encouraged to attend.

Some of us will probably go straight to the Parade afterwards. It might be your only chance to see a Landscapes seminar given by someone who doesn't even have his PhD yet...!

6 November

Dear all,

This week's Parade email will be communicated through the medium of mime. Please come to Eastwood 20/21, office 1.19, to collect your message. Be warned, though, that Geoff is currently trapped behind a large pane of glass, and I am pulling on a very long rope, so it may take us some time to get to the point.

Cheers,
Matt

13 November

Dear all,

What is a drug, and who says what a drug is? This is a tricky area. For this email I use the concept that a drug is an exogenous substance, something that comes from outside a person, goes into them and produces physiological changes.

In the last 40 years we in the UK have developed a way of regulating drugs using a complex legislative framework. There are two major acts of parliament regulating drugs. First, there is the Medicines Act 1968 controlling recreational psychoactive substances. There are a number of other substances that are popularly used and cause harm whose risks fall outside these two control mechanisms. For example, alcohol and tobacco are essentially regulated foods or commodities. Coffee is one of the most popular drugs in the UK and throughout the world. Coffee has relatively unregulated sales. The Misuse of Drugs Act essentially divides drugs into three classes: A, B and C.

I want to make two observations about this. The first is that taking a drug is not currently illegal in this country. The second is that ecstasy is, by my estimation, safer than alcohol and tobacco.

I propose that we replace our regular weekly meet - heretofore known as "Drinks in the Parade" - with a new social event, known as "Ecstasy in the Parade". I see no reason to change the time or place of this gathering (5.30pm ish, after Landscapes

seminar, in the Parade bar).⁵

See you there,
Matt

5. Disclaimer: This email is in no way designed to accurately represent the views of the University of Bath, the Department of Mathematical Sciences, “Drinks in the Parade”, Matt Roberts, or Professor David Nutt. Any relation to the views of Prof Nutt are in no way coincidental.

20 November

Dear all,

Well well well. Here we are again! Friday! In case you needed more reasons than that to come to the Parade bar at 5.30pm, here's The List:

- It's Hubble's birthday. And telescopes are cool.
- It's Mandelbrot's birthday. And fractals are cool.
- It's Tim Gowers' birthday. And Banach spaces with almost no symmetry are cool. So are Fields medallists. And jazz-piano-playing grandsons of Sir Ernest Gowers.
- It's Diocletian's jubilee. And an end to the Crisis of the Third Century is cool.
- Alcohol is good for you.⁶

See you there,
Matt

PS We have 19 so far for bowling on Thursday. Remember to email me before Monday if you want to come along!

6. Maybe. <http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/health/8367141.stm> Soft drinks also available.

Postgrad Bowling! (26 November)

Dear all,

As a break from the usual drinking-based activities (and crazy emails),
we have something slightly more sober planned.

TEN PIN BOWLING!

Now we need to decide when to go. We've narrowed it down to two options:

Thursday 26th November, in the evening (6pm onwards)

OR

Saturday 28th November, in the late afternoon (around 4pm).

To decide, I've stolen Fynn's favourite pastime and created a doodle poll. Please tell us which dates you can make:

<http://www.doodle.com/d3t2dtpcff5vm7bv>

It's at Avonmead Hollywood bowl – some of us will get the train to Bristol, but you're welcome to drive. The cost is £8.50 for two games (although if you only want to play one game, for £4.25, then we can probably arrange that).

All are welcome to come along, including partners and friends.

The plan is to go for something to eat as well as bowling - there is a TGI Friday by the bowling place. But you can just come bowling if you want - and we'll sort that out closer to the time.

Cheers,
Matt et al

27 November

Missing:

Large Rottweiler. Last seen sniffing bums in the Central Bar*. Distinguishing features include unusual orange fur. Unfortunately it was not wearing a collar at the time, but will respond to the call of Fred. If found, please return him to the parade bar at 5:30pm. Also, as a treat please feed him a wham bar and some brandy. Please note that caffeine may kill him.

And onto the quizzes...

This week's quiz question is an easy one: What is the average number of hours that James can remember of a Friday night in Bath.

*As a special bonus this week, we also have a caption competition. See attached photo.

Send your answers to the usual email address:
drunkenfools@paradedrinks.org.

For those that were wondering, the answer to last week's quiz was:

Methionylthreonylthreonylglutaminylarginyltyrosylglutamylserylleucylphenylalanylalanylglutaminylleucyllysylglutamylarginyllysylglutamylglycylalanylphenylalanylvalylprolylphenylalanylvalylthreonylleucylglycylaspartylprolylglucylisoleucylglutamylglutaminylserylleucyllysylisoleucylaspartylthreonylleucylisoleucylglutamylalanylglycylalanylaspartylalanylleucylglutamylleucylglycylisoleucylprolylphenylalanylserylalanyl-

prolylleucylalanylaspartylglycylprolylthreonylsoleucylglutaminyl[...]
serylglutamylasparaginyglutaminyglutaminylserxisoleucine.

Since everyone got the answer correct, the winners will have to share the 6 month rollover prize of a single shot of vodka sherbert. Congratulations.

It's Landscapes lecture day, so see you in Parade after then.

Ray

Ps since there have been some false accusations about us drinking too much on a friday, next week we shall be limiting ourselves to just 2 or 3 bottles of beer each:

http://news.bbc.co.uk/1/hi/scotland/north_east/8380412.stm



4 December

Dear all,

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H6YbLZf8i5I>
Sing along with Noddy!

Are you ready for your weekly Parade call?
It's the time of week that James can't quite recall
Do you buy a red 'shock and beer?
Do you blame it all on Ray?
Does your partner want you sober for a day?

So here it is Parade Drinks Time
Everybody's having fun
Look to the future now
It's only just begun

Are you waiting for the postgrads to arrive?
Are you sure you've got the table space inside?
Does Geoffrey always tell ya, that the brandy is the best?
Then he's drinking blue mohitos with the rest

So here it is Parade Drinks Time
Everybody's having fun
Look to the future now
It's only just begun

What does the barman do when the shout goes up to buy B54s?
AHAAAAAAAAA....

Have you spent your Friday doing bugger all?
Are you longing for that sweet sweet alcohol?
Will you ride on down the hillside, on a bike while you're afraid?
You will crash amongst the cows while singing Slade!

So here it is Parade Drinks Time
Everybody's having fun
Look to the future now
It's only just begun

...IT'S CHRIIISSSSSTTTTMMMMAAAAASSSSS!!!!

(Well, almost!)

See you in the Parade bar, about 5.30pm.

Cheers,
Matt, Ray and Geoff

11 December

Dear all,

Did you make a pass at your lecturer at the Christmas meal last night?

Did you make a horrible joke about Chris Budd and a popular brand of American beer... while Chris was sat behind you?

Did you mistake your internal examiner for Ray and try to balance a pint of beer on her head?

Did you scare off all the staff with your over-enthusiastic dancing?

There's only one cure.

Come on down to the penultimate Parade drinks of the decade to relive the magic! And if your brain is too addled to remember the whole night, I'm sure we can make up some stories to fill in the gaps.

5.30ish - after landscapes. I think it might be a quiet one tonight!

See you there,
Matt

Postgraduate Xmas Party (please read)

Last Christmas my dignity fell apart
And the very next day was hangover for Ray
This year, to save me from tears
I'll give the voddy to someone like Geoffrey

Dear Sir/Madam,

I would like to formally invite you to this years prestigious event that is the Postgraduate Christmas Party. Our very sophisticated computer has picked you out as someone that is regarded highly enough to attend this special occasion. We welcome you all to join us, whether you are a PhD student or a Masters student (old or new).

I would just like to inform you that the date for this will be TUESDAY 15th DECEMBER, and will start from approximately 5pm, so please keep that date free. The event will take place at the Esther Parkin Residence on campus (which is next to Eastwood).

Cost for the event will be a paltry £5, which will guarantee you more fun than a fun thing, that's having a lot of fun. The money covers the cost of renting the place, decorations, as well as extra food and drink. We also ask for everyone to bring an item of food to be shared amongst everyone.

Full details will follow closer to the date, but we would just like to make sure people keep that day free. The last two years have been a great success (ask anyone that has attended), so we hope you can make it this year.

If you would like to help, have an ideas you wish to share, or have any questions, please feel free to contact me.

Yours Sincerely

The Organisers

Postgrad Xmas Party (Important-Please Read!)

Hello folks and folkettes,

Christmas day will finally be here in just less than two weeks time!!! Apologies for the long email but please do read on...

If you didn't know, or had forgotten, the Postgrad xmas party will be held on Tuesday 15th December at the Esther Parkin Residence on campus. If you don't know where that is, it is situated between Eastwood and Marlborough Court:

<http://www.bath.ac.uk/maps/campusmap.html>

We will be starting around 5pm and finish on campus around 11pm (I'm sure the celebrations will continue in town afterwards).

Entry is a measly 5 whole pounds of your cash. This pays for rental of the place, decorations, extra food and soft drinks for you, and as much booze as Geoff can't drink! We will also be providing music and possibly a quiz (one with the right answers as well).

Everyone is welcome to attend, whether you are a Postdoc, PhD student or MSc student, and whether you normally celebrate Christmas or not. If you're worried that this event is for PhD students, then fear not as we have had many Master's students attend in the past. Also feel free to bring along your partners etc, but unfortunately we do draw the line at people bringing their great-grandparents.

I shall be popping round offices at some point to collect money and pester people to attend this great event. Otherwise you can pay Fynn in 1 West 4.19, or Matt if you're in Eastwood.

We also ask people to bring an item of food or drink to be shared amongst everyone. To ensure we all don't bring the same thing, we have set up a page where you can see what everyone else is bring and add what you will bring:

<http://wiki.bath.ac.uk/display/BMX/Bath+Uni+Maths+Postgrad+and+PostDoc+Christmas+Party+2009>

Please let me know if you intend to attend (and whether you will be bringing anyone), especially if you are a MSc student. Please could you also spread the word especially amongst the Master's, in case they don't read this.

Hope to see you all soon

Santa Claus

18 December

Dear all,

I have some messages for you!

The ghost of Parade Drinks past (Nathan) wishes to remind you of the fact that Christmas is not just a happy jolly holiday with presents and food and films on tv. Indeed, we should all remember to celebrate the birth of a very special man... that's right, Sir Isaac Newton was born on Christmas day! Spare him a thought as you're carving up your turkey.

The ghost of Parade Drinks present also has a message for you, but unfortunately it comes in flash player form. Those who have the requisite technology can view the message here:

<http://people.bath.ac.uk/mir20/images/christmas.html>

but the ghost of Parade Drinks present is a generous soul and if you hate macromedia or something you can view an approximation of the message in jpegarized form in the attachment.

The ghost of Parade Drinks future will send you his first message in January. He is blue, but he is not a smurf. He goes by the name of Euan. Look out for him!



And one more message - goodbye! Today is the last Drinks in the Parade of the decade, and my last Drinks in the Parade ever. It's also Nick McCullen's last Drinks in the Parade, so if you're around, please come along and say goodbye! Thanks to everyone who's come along at any point - things are a far cry from back in the day when me and Ray and Geoff used to sit around feeling lonely, have a couple of pints, get fish and chips on the way home and I would fall asleep on the sofa watching Jonathan Woss. From the first crazy nights with Ronnie getting thrown out of the Parade at midnight, through avoiding cows while cycling down the hill, visors, two uneaten curries, teaching Fynn how to say kebab, being mistaken for a three-man stag night, crossing lock gates in the dark, and being recognised by

the Moles bouncers - it's been fun. Keep it up!

See you there – 5.30pm ish. And Merry Christmas!

Cheers,
Matt

